

Data Handling and Retention Standard

Version 4.2 - approved by the Data Protection Board, March 2026.

1. Purpose

- 1.1 This standard defines how customer and transaction data is classified, stored and destroyed.
- 1.2 It applies to every system that processes customer data, including third-party processors.

2. Classification

- 2.1 Every data store must declare a data class before it goes live.
- 2.2 An undeclared store is treated as containing Customer PII until proven otherwise.

3. Retention

- 3.1 Retention periods are fixed and may not be shortened by a project.

Payment instruction - 10 years - Payments Ops

Access log - 18 months - Security

Customer PII - 7 years after closure - Data Protection

4. Destruction

- 4.1.1 Deletion must be irreversible; a soft-delete flag does not satisfy this standard.
- 4.1.2 Backups containing expired data must be rotated out within one backup cycle.